

Travis Nickels

Technology Leader

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Thirteen years running technology delivery for a six-hospital system, where I also built the internal tools, the department ran on. Then four years of engineering distributed systems, and most recently taking products from zero to production for early-stage companies, including a detection prototype and the market analysis presented to the board. Working under HIPAA and Sarbanes-Oxley shaped how I approach consumer health technology: what a product tells a customer must be something the organization can defend. I architect for near-zero marginal cost, because at an early-stage company infrastructure spend is runaway.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Technology Consultant · Remote

2025 – Present

On-Device Computer Vision Prototype · Client confidential

- Built a cross-platform mobile application with a complete on-device machine learning pipeline, from concept to working prototype in under a month. Trained a custom object detection model, exported it to a mobile runtime, and bundled it inside the application binary.
- Selected on-device inference over cloud processing so infrastructure cost stays near flat as usage scales rather than rising with every scan and modeled the difference at volume in the architecture proposal.
- Built remotely tunable model configuration so domain experts can adjust detection parameters across every installation without requiring an application release.
- Designed an offline-first data layer so the application functions without connectivity, with cloud synchronization as an enhancement rather than a dependency.
- Used off-the-shelf training and export tooling with an existing public dataset rather than building either, keeping engineering effort on the inference pipeline and the application.
- Produced the market and competitive analysis that accompanied the technical work at executive level.

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- Sole developer and architect of a Spanish and English platform for direct sales leaders managing consultant teams, built and shipped alone from architecture through production operations.
- Designed a contracts-first architecture across three repositories in which shared TypeScript contracts enforce type safety from the API through to the frontend at compile time.
- Built on Nuxt 4 and Cloudflare Pages with an API on Cloudflare Workers and Supabase PostgreSQL with row-level security. Fully serverless, with no fixed infrastructure cost before the product is profitable.
- Built Google Calendar synchronization that reconciles in place, preserves record identity across updates, and surfaces genuinely ambiguous conflicts to the user rather than silently choosing.
- Diagnosed a production outage caused by a server-side bundle exceeding the edge platform's size limit, which produced no application-level logs, then added bundle-size checks to the build pipeline so the failure class cannot recur silently.
- Own production infrastructure directly: Cloudflare deployments, Supabase schema management, DNS across two custom domains, secret rotation, and staging environment parity.

- Delivered the fix for a vendor-introduced message loss risk after a queue policy default changed upstream. Designed and implemented automatic detection and correction through the vendor management API, coordinated the change across the transport library and desktop tooling, and preserved backward compatibility so existing customers required no action.
- Contributed to the migration of a production monitoring application from AngularJS to Vue and authored the internal architecture documentation the team worked from.
- Built the behavior-driven testing framework and domain-specific language used for frontend validation, testing what the system does rather than how it does it.
- Participated in architecture reviews and design proposals for cross-transport message bridging, identifying real-world edge cases and building the validation coverage that reduced rollout risk.
- Analyzed support request trends across rotations and used the data to justify a customer portal that reduced inbound spam to near zero.
- Presented squad updates at company-wide town halls and facilitated retrospectives for task forces.

- Ran roughly 50 technology projects annually across six acute care hospitals and affiliated facilities: new facility construction, department launches, infrastructure upgrades, and third-party integrations.
- Led IT delivery for the Cerner electronic medical record conversion supporting 2,000+ users across 3,000+ devices, coordinating contractors for network and power installation, equipment delivery and setup timelines, clinical training, and third-party system integration with the corporate office.
- Participated in budgeting, planning, and implementation with the executive team, delivering regular status and budget reporting to the C-suite.
- Served as the translation layer between clinical staff, technical teams, and hospital leadership, aligning technology delivery with clinical operations.
- Built a custom .NET project tracking platform replacing spreadsheets and SharePoint, giving leadership visibility across all six facilities in one place.
- Operated throughout under HIPAA and Sarbanes-Oxley requirements, in an environment where documentation and auditability carried the same weight as delivery.

TECHNICAL CAPABILITY

Product & Architecture Distributed systems, event-driven design, cost modeling, build versus buy

Machine Learning & Vision Python, YOLOv8, TensorFlow Lite, on-device inference, model training, annotation pipelines

Backend C#, .NET Core, Node.js, Hono, REST, GraphQL, NServiceBus, RabbitMQ, Azure Service Bus, Amazon SQS

Frontend & Mobile TypeScript, Vue 3, Nuxt 4, React Native, JavaScript

Data PostgreSQL, Supabase with row-level security, SQL Server, edge key-value storage

Cloud & Infrastructure Cloudflare Workers and Pages, Azure Functions, AWS, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker

Testing Behavior-driven development, Vitest, Testing Library, Mock Service Worker, integration testing

Compliance HIPAA, Sarbanes-Oxley, GDPR

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science University of California, Riverside · Undergraduate research, Graphics Lab